Jammu & Kashmir Force, with two subordinate divisions, namely the Srinagar and Jammu & Kashmir divisions. They were subsequently to become XV Corps and 19 and 26 divisions respectively.

The first operations conducted by the newly created formation headquarters towards Muzaffarabad were only partly successful. Pakistan had deployed two regular brigades to reinforce the militias and had positioned five more brigades between Muzaffabarad and Mirpur. While 163 Infantry Brigade's northern thrust managed to seize Tithwal and Keren on 23 May 1948, the southern attack, launched from Uri by two brigades (161 Infantry and 77 Parachute), was unsuccessful. In June, 19 Infantry Brigade made another unsuccessful attempt to relieve Poonch. It was only in October–November 1948 that an operation by 5, 19 and 268 Infantry brigades, supported by armour and air assets, succeeded in lifting the siege.

In the north, Pakistani forces seized Skardu, Kargil and Dras but failed to capture Leh where two newly arrived Gorkha companies, one from 2/4 GORKHA RIFLES and the other from 2/8 GORKHA RIFLES, beat back repeated attacks. With Pakistani forces holding the Zojila Pass in strength, initial Indian attempts to take back Dras and Kargil failed, but the employment of a squadron of Indian armour at Zojila turned the tables. The Indian Army was able to rout the Pakistani forces and retake Dras and Kargil by the end of November, in the war's last significant combat operations. Fighting continued for a month or so but was primarily to improve existing positions and had no significant effect on the conclusion of the conflict.

At this stage, India was close to victory, but chose to refer the matter to the United Nations. A ceasefire came into effect on 1 January 1949 with the two sides retaining their positions. The Cease Fire Line was drawn up based on the actual holding of ground by India and Pakistan, pending future settlements. This line ran some 700km from Chhamb in the south, near the town of Akhnur, to a map reference point known as NJ 9842 in Ladakh in the north. The line hereafter ran northwards towards the glaciers. This was the start of a conflict between India and Pakistan that continues at the time of writing.